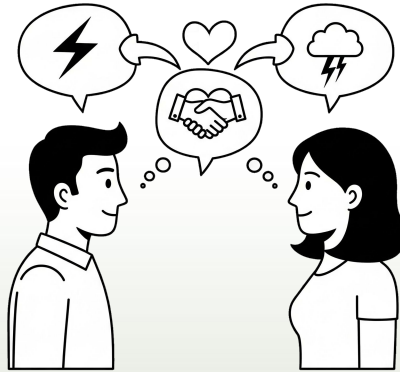


Intentional Parenting

Conflict Resolution



Last Week's Assignment

Ask your spouse:
What brings you joy?

Ask yourself:
What can I do this week to foster that?



Intentional Parenting

1. Framework Overview
(Feb 22)
2. Mindset Part 1 (Mar 1)
3. Mindset Part 2 (Mar 8)
4. Marriage (Mar 15)
5. Conflict Resolution
(Mar 22)
6. Discipline Part 1 (Mar 29)
7. Discipline Part 2 (Apr 12)
8. School and Technology
(Apr 19)
9. Coaching Plan (Apr 26)
10. Wrapup (May 3)



Conflict Resolution

Where does conflict show up most in your home —
between you and your spouse, between your kids, or
between you and your kids?



The Biblical Frame: Shalom

- God's original design: *shalom* — wholeness, harmony, flourishing (Genesis 1–2)
- Conflict is not part of the original design — it is an intruder
- God is restoring shalom — and calls us to be part of that restoration in our homes



Genesis 3



The Fall — Four Broken Relationships

- **Vertical** — humanity against God: “I was afraid... I hid” (Gen. 3:10)
- **Horizontal** — husband against wife: “The woman you gave me...” (Gen. 3:12)
- **Internal** — shame, fear, self-concealment
- **Environmental** — the ground itself cursed



*“What causes quarrels and what causes fights
among you?*

*Is it not this, that your **passions are at war
within you?**”*

James 4:1–3



Not All Conflict Is Equal

1. **Sinful conflict** — driven by pride, envy, selfishness (works of the flesh, Galatians 5:19–21) → *repent of it*
2. **Righteous conflict** — contending for truth and love (Nathan confronting David, Gal. 2:11) → *embrace it*
3. **Unavoidable conflict**—between Christ and world, suffering for righteousness (1 Pet. 3:14-17) → *endure it*
4. **Disagreement** – between two points of view. Issue-based. Not personal (Paul and Silas, Acts 15:36–41) → *wisdom to engage*



Peacemaker

*Blessed are the peacemakers, for they
shall be called sons of God.*

Matthew 5:9



Peacekeeper

*The peacekeeper's primary goal is the **absence of conflict** — silence, surface harmony, and the avoidance of anything that might disturb the relational atmosphere.*



Peacemaker

*The peacemaker's goal is **restored right relationship** — which sometimes requires walking through conflict rather than around it.*



Peacekeeper vs Peacemaker

	Peacekeeper	Peacemaker
Goal	Absence of conflict — avoidance, silence, self-protection	Restored right relationship — honest, loving engagement
Method	Avoidance, silence, deflection	Honest, loving engagement
Motive	Self-protection, fear, comfort	Love for God and neighbor
View of conflict	Something to escape	Something to redeem
Biblical parallel	“Kiss of an enemy” (Prov. 27:6)	Nathan confronting David (2 Sam. 12)
Short-term effect	Feels peaceful	May feel uncomfortable
Long-term effect	Resentment, distance, decay	Potential for genuine shalom (peace)
Theologically	Confuses “quiet” with shalom	The ministry of reconciliation (2 Cor. 5)



Practical Tips



Practical tips

1. **Understand yourself** – your own tendencies and motivations
2. **Praise in public**, confront in private
3. **O I C**
4. Practice the **4 G's**



O I C

O - Observe

I - Interpret

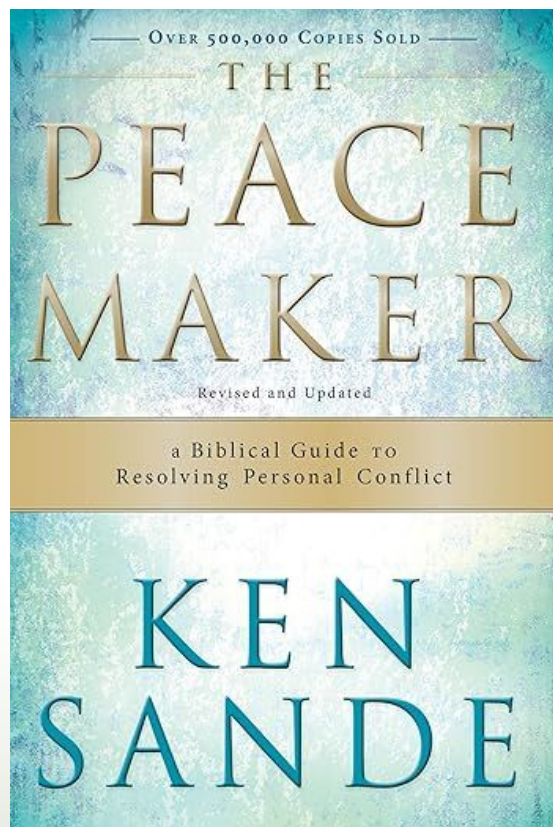
C - Clarify



The 4 G's

- **Glorify God** — How can I honor God in how I handle this?
- **Get the log out** — What is my own contribution to this conflict? (Matt. 7:3–5)
- **Gently restore** — Lovingly and honestly address the other person (Gal. 6:1)
- **Go and be reconciled** — Commit to rebuilding the relationship (Matt. 18)





Assignment

This week, when conflict breaks out in your home — pause
before you respond.

Am I about to be a peacekeeper or a peacemaker?

What is my heart doing right now? (James 4:1)

